

Solid wood and manufactured boards

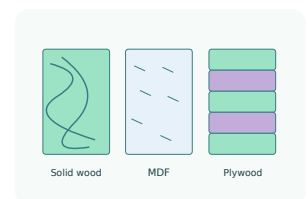
A material family is not a complete specification. Identify its structure, then compare the actual products and supporting data before selecting construction details.

What you will accomplish

- Identify the material structure
- Request data for the actual product
- Relate the material to the whole construction

Identify the material structure

Inspect an identified cross-section. Distinguish solid wood and its grain from plywood veneer layers and an MDF fibre-based panel. A facing can hide the core, so specify core and face separately. A wood appearance does not establish that the entire board is solid timber.



The cross-section separates core from facing.

Request data for the actual product

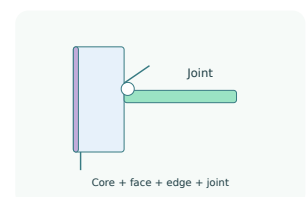
Record the product code, thickness, sheet size, grade and declared use. Request data relevant to the environment and proposed fixing system. Do not infer water resistance or joint capacity from a family name alone; different grades and constructions require review of the actual product data.

Product data	
Code	Grade
Thickness	Use
Compatibility data	

Connect performance claims to an identified product and grade.

Relate the material to the whole construction

Compare alternatives for the same part and use. Review core, thickness, facing, edges, joints and finish as a system, and record missing data. If the product changes after drawing issue, recheck details, schedules and samples. The same colour does not establish the same construction requirements.



Product substitution triggers a review of details and schedules.

Worked case and decision

Two veneered boards look alike but have different cores and grades. The brief is a cabinet in a dry interior; hinge and fixing compatibility are still unconfirmed.

Decision: compare product data and joint details before accepting a substitute based on appearance.

Check understanding

What supports accepting a board substitution?

- The same colour
- Product data and compatible construction for the stated use
- The same family name alone

Correct: Product data and compatible construction for the stated use. A matching facing does not establish core identity or fixing compatibility.

Lesson questions

Should I immediately choose the cheaper sheet?

First confirm compatibility, then compare the whole cost including edges, finishing, waste and supply.

Practice

Compare two identified products and list the data still needed before selection.

Core, facing and grade

Use and construction compatibility

Missing data and decision

Review your work against the criteria. Saving it does not constitute technical project approval.

- The product and grade are identified
- Core and facing are separate
- Performance claims have product-specific evidence